Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition
Integrated Delivery
Metrolinx, 97 Front Street West, Toronto, ON

Re: Sponsor Officer, GO Expansion

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Sponsor Officer, GO Expansion position in the Integrated Delivery division. I worked at Metrolinx in 2023 as a Transportation Planner in Service Design, testing GO service plans in simulation, and since January 2024 I have been an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto.

The role is about taking unclear issues through to a decision: working out the key questions, building the evidence, and writing it up so that senior management can act. That is the shape of my work at the City. I run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, write the briefing notes that come out of them, and present to planners, engineers and managers in other divisions. I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward, and worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers on service design decisions. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions. So I know the GO network, and the questions a service increase raises, from the operating side.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not worked in a sponsor or benefits-realization role, managed against a business case, or taken items through governance approvals, and I have not managed a portfolio of initiatives. I do not hold a P.Eng., RPP or PMP, which the posting lists as assets.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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